Hilina Workneh

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SUMMARY

Backend software engineer with **5+ years** building distributed services in Go and Python. Currently building the **Azure NetApp Files Virtual Storage Appliance**, the software-defined platform replacing dedicated bare-metal storage and expected to serve a **petabyte-scale** footprint, in partnership with Microsoft. Earlier, delivered the **first BlueXP Data Lake service** on ClickHouse and an enterprise identity federation service. Two-time Spot Award recipient.

EDUCATION

North Carolina A&T State University, M.S. Electrical Engineering, GPA 3.80/4.00 — Aug 2021 | Greensboro, NC

Addis Ababa Science and Technology University, B.S. Electrical and Computer Engineering, GPA 3.25/4.00 — Jul 2018 | Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

NetApp Inc — Nov 2021 - Present
Software Engineer III — Dallas, TX

Azure NetApp Files: Virtual Storage Appliance (current)

- Building the **Virtual Storage Appliance (VSA) platform** that runs NetApp ONTAP on Azure virtual machines, moving Azure NetApp Files off dedicated bare-metal hardware onto elastic, software-defined infrastructure.
- The platform is expected to carry a **petabyte-scale storage footprint**, letting Azure NetApp Files add capacity and regions in software instead of waiting on new hardware installs.
- Develop the deployment, networking, and **high-availability** workflows that keep customer data available when a node fails over, working directly with **Microsoft** engineering.

BlueXP platform services

- Delivered NetApp's **first BlueXP Data Lake service**: high-throughput ingest and parallel query APIs on distributed **ClickHouse**. Earned a **Spot Award** for impact and execution.
- Built the **Enterprise Federation service** connecting SAML, ADFS, and Azure AD identity providers through OIDC/OAuth2, with automated signing-certificate expiry alerts.
- Implemented RBAC/IAM access control and domain APIs for creation, validation, and ownership verification, and **led the tenancy and authorization migration from MySQL to MongoDB**. Wrote the OpenAPI specs shared across teams.
- Train and mentor **new hires** through onboarding, code review, and pairing on production services.

Capacity forecasting and analytics

- Built the **"days to full" forecasting algorithm** that predicts when customer storage runs out, presented it to engineering leadership, and applied machine learning to manageability telemetry. Earned a **Spot Award**.

PROJECTS

MahberHub (IdirHub) — Startup

- Building a mobile-first platform that digitizes Idir and Mahber community groups, replacing paper ledgers and cash collection with transparent membership, contribution, and announcement tools.
- Developing the Go and PostgreSQL backend: **30+ REST endpoints** for groups, members, invites, and contributions, with JWT login and Twilio phone verification.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go; Python; TypeScript; Java; JavaScript; SQL; Bash
Cloud & Infrastructure: Azure (VNet, NICs, load balancer, ARM, Entra ID); Kubernetes; Docker
Storage & Networking: NetApp ONTAP; NFS; high-availability takeover and giveback; subnets, CIDR, and VNet injection
Data & Identity: PostgreSQL; ClickHouse; MongoDB; MySQL; Kafka; JWT; OIDC; OAuth2; SAML; ADFS; RBAC/IAM
Tools & Practices: Gin; Twilio; React Native (Expo); OpenAPI; Postman; Git; Jira; GitHub Actions; TeamCity; Jenkins; Elasticsearch; Kibana; Prometheus; Grafana; Linux

AWARDS

NetApp Spot Award

- Delivering the first BlueXP Data Lake microservice — Jan 2024
- "Days to full" forecasting algorithm and its presentation to engineering leadership — Feb 2022